

GNIOT Institute of Management Studies – PGDM (Batch 2020-22)**(TRIMESTER – IV) END TERM EXAMINATION, OCTOBER - 2021****INNOVATION AND PRODUCT MANAGEMENT****[Time: 2 Hours 30 Minutes]****[Maximum Marks: 100]****INSTRUCTIONS:**

- (i) **There are THREE sections in this question paper.**
- (ii) **Attempt questions from each section as per the directions.**
- (iii) **Make suitable assumptions wherever necessary.**

SECTION-A**(Short Answer Type Questions, do not exceed 100 words)****Q.1. Attempt all parts of the following:****(10×3=30)**

- (a) Define innovation.
- (b) Explain the difference between technology push model and market pull model.
- (c) Give an example of structure type of innovation.
- (d) What are trademarks? Give example.
- (e) How can supplier relations be a strategic alliance for a company?
- (f) Differentiate between products and services.
- (g) Explain incremental innovation in context of smartphones.
- (h) Are department stage models a good fit for modern companies?
- (i) Is Silicon valley an example of science park model? Why/why not?
- (j) Conversion process models treat innovation as a chaotic process. Comment.

SECTION-B**(Long Answer Type Questions)****Attempt all questions of the following:****(4×10=40)****Q.2. (a) As an innovation manager of the company, what are the various innovation types available to you?****OR****(b) Design a framework for management of innovation.****Q.3. (a) Explain Pearson's uncertainty map with examples.****OR****(b) Discuss the contrast between mechanistic structures and organic structures.****Q.4. (a) What are strategic alliances? Discuss ways in which a company can form alliances with other companies.****OR****(b) 'The whole can be viewed as more than the sum of the parts.' Comment on this statement in view of knowledge base of an organization.**

Q.5. (a) A new product of your company is ready to launch. What techniques will you use to test the product before it is launched in the market?

OR

(b) Design a matrix structure for a company. Also state benefits of using matrix structures.

SECTION-C

(Case study)

Since the first Dell PC was introduced in 1986, Dell has continued to shape the industry by breaking new ground and pioneering critical developments in home, small business and enterprise computing. The Dell business connects with more than 5.4 billion customers every day with earnings of \$14.9 billion comprising a net profit of \$584 million. The core of Dell computers is always been in innovation approach with a commitment to deliver new and better solutions and technologies that fulfils and meets demands and customer needs. They accept Partnerships with varied industry such as software, hardware and component suppliers and by generating a uniquely broad perspective on the computing world and the accessories. Dell believes in innovations which begin in-house supported by global team of top engineers, product designers and technical experts. Along with a team effort with Dell's strategic partners to formulate and implement the different strategies. Their mission is to deliver innovative and cost-effective solutions that meet today's customer requirements and innovative work seamlessly is carried out in existing environments and their products.

Dell is uniquely positioned into the market which has a strong impact on the industry trends. They maintain strong internal and in-house development capabilities. They have a strategy to be partners, rather than to compete, with top technology suppliers and manufacturers. They enable industry standards and technologies through industry groups and strategic partners. In such a way Dell innovates and delivers value and needs of customers. Dell really a superb product integrator and also tremendously good sales-and-logistics company. As Fortune magazine wrote: "A Dell mantra is that today's technology is tomorrow's commodity. Dell waits until the cost of that technology falls low enough for it to be stuffed into computers at state-of-the-art factories and then sold direct at a cheap price, which allows the company to drive for share." The focus point of Dell's innovation approach, however, remains an unwavering commitment to delivering new and better solutions that directly address customer needs. Dell start their innovation process with asking their customers, "What would you really want this thing to do? Is there a different way to accomplish that?" Then they meet with their suppliers and ask, "Can we do this in a different way?" Then they try to come up with a totally different approach that exceeds the original objectives.

Dell understands the necessity directly through tens of thousands of customer interactions, organized events, social media venues such as Ideastorm, communities and customer panels. Partnerships with a wide variety of key industry software, hardware and component suppliers give them a unique viewpoint on Dell future products and Services.

Q.6. Attempt all parts of the following:

(2×15=30)

Case Questions

6 (a) What measures has Dell taken to encourage innovation in the company?

6 (b) Suggest few ideas on how Dell can improve its position in the industry.